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Pakistan has spent too many years looking for quick fixes when its cricket really needs continuity

People come in, bring their own people, change the format, **change the First-Class structure** and, six months, nine months or a year later, they are gone.



Mudassar Nazar

I have seen Pakistan cricket change its system so often that we have rarely given any system enough time to work.

For decades, we have chopped and changed First-Class cricket, tournaments, academies and the people running the game.

Every new chairman seems to bring a new idea. Instead of looking at our

structure, our grounds and pitches, we keep trying to change the system.

I have been part of that system as a player and a coach. I have seen good initiatives start, produce players and then disappear. I have seen academies built and allowed to deteriorate. I have seen players come into international cricket without enough domestic cricket behind them.

When we talk about Pakistan cricket's problems today, I don't think we can blame one series, one coach or one selection committee.

The problem is much deeper. We have spent too many years looking for quick fixes when Pakistan cricket really needs continuity.

We are paying for that now.

I remember one tournament from the start of my career, in 1974-75, which I really enjoyed and found very challenging. I was playing for Pakistan International Airlines and, soon afterwards, for Pakistan Universities.

That year, Abdul Hafeez Kardar, the former captain of Pakistan, had imported Australian grass, and we played on grass pitches in Punjab, mainly in Lahore.

In the winter months, in January and February, the ball tended to do quite a lot. I had the highest number of catches in the slips that year. We had normal swing bowling, and not many people got runs.

A couple of years later, that tournament was gone. It had the five best teams in the country.

Unfortunately, that is what has happened over the years. Monday it is one tournament, the next day it is another. We seem to believe that if we start another competition, we will find the solution.

But the solution is not always a new tournament. Sometimes you have to look at what you already